



THE WORLD BANK
IBRD • IDA

FISCAL YEAR 2024 ANNUAL REPORT

ACCESS TO INFORMATION



Man on horseback in Uzbekistan, May 1994.(30215340, Credit: World Bank Group)

INTRODUCTION

Fiscal Year 2024 (FY24) marked significant progress in the World Bank’s commitment to transparency and public access to information. The Bank introduced major upgrades to the Open Knowledge Repository and Documents & Reports platform, making research, data, and official documents more accessible and discoverable. The launch of the Reproducible Research Repository and improvements to open data platforms further advanced transparency and accountability in development research. The Archives continued to expand public access by declassifying and digitizing hundreds of thousands of pages of historical records.

Efforts to enhance user experience included upgraded email alert systems, enriched discovery platforms, and new digital preservation tools, all of which empower stakeholders to engage with World Bank information more effectively. The first meeting of the Open Science Community and the rollout of the Records Management Maturity Assessment Toolkit underscored the Bank’s dedication to open knowledge and best practices. Collectively, these achievements reflect ongoing efforts to broaden public access and foster greater accountability.

OPEN DATA

At the World Bank, the Development Data Group coordinates statistical and data work and maintains a number of macro, financial and sector databases. Working closely with the Bank’s Regional Units and Global Practices, the group is guided by professional standards in the collection, compilation and dissemination of data to ensure their quality and integrity.

Page views: **Over 100 million**

Downloads: **Over 3.2 million**

Available datasets: **16,788**

GENERAL INQUIRIES

In FY 24, the World Bank received and responded to a diverse range of general inquiries from individuals, civil society, the private sector, and academia. A total of 359 inquiries were processed. There was a significant increase in requests related to financing and project procurement.



Environment exhibit for Bank's World, 1992 (1798195, Credit: World Bank Group),

OPEN ACCESS

The World Bank’s Open Access (OA) Directive enables the widest possible dissemination of its research and knowledge and increases the users’ ability to discover and use pertinent information. In FY24, the Open Knowledge Repository (OKR), the Bank’s official open-access repository, completed its first major upgrade in over six years. OKR now offers an API service, a more accessible Angular user interface, and more links to selected data sets from the World Bank Data Catalog, including reproducible data when available. The OKR focuses on research and publications from 2000 to present, to provide open access to knowledge most likely to contribute to solving current development challenges around the world. These enhancements create a strong foundation for use and discovery of World Bank knowledge and research.

In December 2023, Documents & Reports (D&R), the official disclosure platform for the Access to Information Policy, reached a significant milestone, surpassing 500,000 records. D&R hosts final and official documents dating from 1946 to the present. To promote evidence-based policymaking, support countries in overcoming challenges, and unlock opportunities for sustainable and inclusive growth, key country analytics and flagship reports from D&R are now prominently featured on [Data 360](#) — the World Bank’s new open data and analytics platform. Together, the OKR and the D&R repositories provide access to a vast collection of World Bank documents and reports.

Launched in July 2023, the [Reproducible Research Repository](#) is a key World Bank initiative that advances transparency and accountability in research. By providing comprehensive reproducibility packages—including analytical scripts, documentation, and, where possible, the data used in studies—it enables users to replicate findings and build on original research. This commitment to openness enhances the impact of the Bank’s work, aligning with its broader mission to promote informed decision-making and transparency.

DOCUMENTS AND REPORTS

Downloads in FY24
41,540,030

OPEN KNOWLEDGE REPOSITORY

Abstract Views in FY24
3,977,153

Downloads in FY24
7,712,479



Women receiving vocational training, Muctagacha, Bangladesh, 1979 (30452838, Credit: World Bank Group/Kay Chernush),

OPEN ARCHIVES

Access to historical information

The Bank continues to provide excellent transparency and access to historical information through key platforms such as the Documents and Reports repository, the Projects and Operations database, and the World Bank Group Archives Catalog. The resources serve as vital tools for researchers, development practitioners, and the public to explore the institution’s history and its contribution to global development.

In FY 24, 164 researchers accessed 523,446 pages of archival records declassified under the Access to Information Policy. Of these, over 380,000 pages of archival records were declassified this fiscal year. In addition to declassification efforts, the Archives digitized more than 400,000 pages of archival records and made them accessible online. The demand for these records underscores their value, with nearly 4 million pages downloaded over 190,000 times.

Pages declassified in FY24 **380,597**

Pages digitized in FY24 **412,704**

Reports proactively disclosed **145**

Downloads FY24 **192,312**

Number of Researchers **164**

Number of Pages Researched **523,446**



Construction workers at site of Jordan Fertilizer Industry Company plant, Aqaba, Jordan, 1980 (1724633, World Bank Group/Kay Chernush),

OTHER HIGHLIGHTS

Bretton Woods @80 Exhibit

The Archives, in collaboration with External and Corporate Relations, Corporate Secretariat and Development Economics vice presidencies, launched an expansive exhibit commemorating the 80th anniversary of the Bretton Woods Conference. The exhibit, which was installed in the atrium of the World Bank Group's Main Complex, featured a diverse offering of interactive resources, including archival documents and photographs, discovery platform access via iPads, and audio/visual elements. The opening of the exhibit coincided with an anniversary event organized by the Office of the President during which President Banga and Bank Group staff reflected on the history and future of our organization.

Digital Preservation

In FY24, the Bank made significant strides in enhancing its digital preservation capabilities to ensure the secure and sustainable management of its most valuable information assets. Key accomplishments include:

- The production instance of the Bank's digital preservation platform, Preservica, was successfully upgraded to the latest version, improving functionality and performance
- Single-sign-on (SSO) was enabled and fully operational in the production environment, streamlining user access and improving security.
- A major upgrade to the Content Manager platform was completed, ensuring better integration with digital preservation workflows and enhanced support for archival materials.

These achievements reflect the Bank's ongoing commitment to leveraging advanced technology to preserve its institutional memory and provide sustainable access to its digital assets for future generations.



OTHER HIGHLIGHTS

E-Mail Alerts

Email Alerts continue to serve as a critical channel for keeping the public informed, delivering customized emails announcing newly disclosed reports, events, blogs, microdata sets, and procurement notices. In FY 24 significant enhancements were made to improve user experience and expand outreach. Signup boxes were added to all external World Bank country pages, making it easier for visitors to subscribe. Additionally, user gained the ability to customize their preferences for procurement information, choosing between opportunities or awards based on their interests.

These improvements contributed to a robust increase in subscriptions, with an additional 5,000 subscriptions added during the year, bringing the total of over 17,000 active subscriptions. Engagement remained strong, with 1.3 million emails delivered in FY24, averaging 3,500 emails sent daily to subscribers worldwide. These updates demonstrate the Bank's commitment to leveraging technology to ensure relevant, and targeted communication with its diverse audience.

Enhancements to Flagship Discovery Platforms

The Archives updated two of its most engaging discovery platforms during FY24. The Information & Technology Solutions (ITS) award-winning [Country Historical Profiles](#) brings together relevant historical information and resources for each World Bank Group member country, past and present. Enhancements include an expanded offering of curated resources and improved navigation. Updates to the [World Bank Group Historical Timeline](#) further enrich the narrative of the institution's 80-year history, adding new milestones and accompanying resources exploring more than a dozen important events in our institution's history as well as events focusing on the tenure of former World Bank Group President David Malpass. These updates not only broaden the scope of accessible knowledge, but also deepen engagement with the Bank's historical legacy, fostering greater understanding of its contributions to global development.

Open Science

In May 2024, the World Bank Open Science Community convened its first meeting, offering an overview of Open Science and providing updates from different teams across the institution. Open Science is a key part of the Knowledge Compact and is essential to improving how the Bank shares with and learns from our partners and the public. As a cross-cutting initiative, the Open Science leverages the work of decentralized teams encompassing diverse areas such as open data, open access, reproducible research, open source, citizen data, and access to information. By fostering greater transparency, collaboration, and innovation, the Open Science initiative reinforces the Bank's commitment to evidence-based decision-making and inclusive development outcomes.

WBG Records Management Maturity Assessment Toolkit

Following the launch of the WBG [Records Management Roadmap Toolkit](#), designed to help governments and public-sector organizations implement strategic and coordinated improvements in records management, the Archives team led various toolkit socialization activities.

Key initiatives included [Roadshows and workshops](#) for Development Academy of Bangsamoro for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM) and the [Philippine Civil Service Commission](#) (CSC) in the Philippines. These sessions focused on equipping stakeholders with practical tools and strategies to strengthen transparency, accountability, and access to information through improved records management.

In Kenya the toolkit was used for Records and Information Management maturity assessment in pilot municipalities in support for implementation of RIM component in [Kenya Urban Support Program](#). These efforts aim to enhance institutional capacity, improve service delivery, and foster greater trust through open and accountable governance.

Access to Information Requests Handled*

Fiscal year in which the ATI request was created	Number of ATI requests Handled	Number of ATI requests Closed	Percentage of ATI requests Closed	Number of ATI requests which remained Open
FY2024	598	545	91	53
FY2023	45	44	98	1
Total	643	589	92	54

*Handled – The request was created in FY2024 or was carried over from previous fiscal years as an open case.

Requests Fulfilled (in Whole or in Part) or Denied

Of the 589 requests closed in FY 24, 429 requests provided sufficient information and were handled by the ATI system. 417 requests were fulfilled in whole or in part, and 12 requests were denied without fulfilling any part of the request.

The way the remaining 160 were handled is described in in the table titled “Manner in Which the Remaining Cases Were Handled” on page 17.

Indicator	Requests Fulfilled in Whole	Requests Fulfilled in Part	Total Number of Requests Fulfilled in Whole or in Part
Total number	365	52*	417
Percent (%) of total	88%	12%	100%

*Of the 52 requests that were fulfilled in part, the outcomes were due to the following reasons:

- The information was restricted by the “Deliberative Information” (four requests)
- The information was not in custody of the World Bank (five requests)
- The request was considered unreasonable (seven requests)
- The requester was unresponsive (two requests)
- Part of the request was handled through the Development Data and other World Bank Initiatives (thirty-two requests)
- Part of the request was a referred to IEG and Development Data Initiative (one request)
- Part of the information was not found in the custody of the World Bank and part was restricted by the “Information provided by Member Countries or Third Parties in Confidence” and “Deliberative Information” (one request)

Requests Denied

Of the 429 requests handled by the ATI system and closed in FY 24, twelve requests were denied without fulfilling any part of the request.

Indicator	Requests Denied
Total Number	12

Of the 12 requests that were denied in whole or in part without fulfilling any part of the request, the outcomes were due to the following reasons:

- The information was restricted by the Information Provided by Member Countries or Third Parties in Confidence exception (four requests)
- The information was restricted by the Corporate Administrative Matters exception (three requests)
- The information was restricted by the Deliberative Information exception (one request)
- The information was restricted by the Attorney-Client Privilege exception (one request)
- The information was restricted by the Deliberative Information and the Information Provided by Member Countries or Third Parties in Confidence exception (one request)
- The information was restricted by the Safety and Security and the Information Provided by Member Countries or Third Parties in Confidence exceptions (one request)
- The information was restricted by the Safety and Security, the Corporate Administrative Matters and the Information Provided by Member Countries or Third Parties in Confidence exceptions (one request)

Manner in Which the Remaining Cases were Handled

As mentioned previously, of the 589 requests closed in FY 24, were handled by the Access to Information system and a response was provided. The remaining 160 requests were handled as follows:

Indicator	Numbers of Requests
Referral to Development Data and other World Bank initiatives	123
Unresponsive requestor	24
Exception 6	6
Referrals to IFC and ICSID	4
Records not Found in World Bank Custody	2
Records not Found in World Bank Custody and Unreasonable Request	1
Total	160

Timeliness of Requests Closed

The Bank acknowledges receipt of written requests for information within five working days, and endeavors to provide a more comprehensive response within 20 working days.

Indicator	Number of Requests	Percentage of Requests (%)
Requests closed within 20 working days	481	81
Requests closed after 20 working days	108	19
Total number of Requests Closed	589	100

Appeals Concluded by the Access to Information Committee (AIC)

Case number and information requested	Violation of ATI Policy	Public Interest	Upheld or Reversed World Bank decision to Deny Access	Applicable Exception(s)
Case No. AI8644 Climate Change Adaptation and Mitigation Co-Benefits by Sector for all IBRD/IDA Project (Investment, DPF & PforR) from 2002 to the present (Decision dated September 13, 2023)	X		Dismissed	

Dismissed means that the appeal is not considered on its merits and is, therefore, rejected, because (a) the requester failed to file the appeal within the required time; (b) the requester failed to provide sufficient information that would reasonably support the appeal; or (c) the requester appealed a matter that the AIC does not have the authority to consider (e.g., decisions by the Board).

Appeals Concluded by the Access to Information Appeals Board (AIAB)

Case number and information requested	Upheld or Reversed ATI Committee’s decision upholding World Bank Decision to Deny Access	Applicable Exception(s)
Case No. AI8644: Climate Change Adaptation and Mitigation Co-Benefits by Sector for all IBRD/IDA Project (Investment, DPF & PforR) from 2002 to the present (Decision dated June 14, 2024).	Dismissed	

Dismissed means that the appeal is not considered on its merits because (a) the requester failed to file the appeal within the required time; (b) the requester failed to provide sufficient information that would reasonably support the appeal; or (c) the requester appealed a matter that the AIAB did not have the authority to consider (e.g., decisions by the Board)



Documents & Reports

is the official disclosure mechanism for more than 380,000 documents starting from the 1940s that enables sharing of the institution's extensive knowledge base and implementing its access to information policy.



The World Bank Group Archives

offers a variety of online historical resources and information products, such as ISAD(G) finding aids, transcripts of oral history interviews, and exhibits featuring the Archives' collection and World Bank history.



Projects & Operations

provides access to basic information on all of the World Bank's lending projects from 1947 to the present.



The Open Knowledge Repository

is the Bank's official open access repository and is interoperable with other open access repositories. It offers a robust range of usage statistics, including those by title, series, country, and author.



The Open Government Partnership

is a multilateral initiative that secures concrete commitments from governments to promote transparency, empower citizens and fight corruption.



World Bank Group Finances

makes data related to the WBG's financials available to everybody in a social, interactive, visually compelling, and machine readable format.



Open Data Initiative

provides free and open access to thousands of development data indicators.



International Aid Transparency Initiative

is a global campaign to create transparency in the records of how aid money is spent. The World Bank is an IATI member and publishes data on a quarterly basis.